The Five Terms and the Assignment Structure

Command of the vocabulary is not the goal. Command of the consequence is.

From ***AI Will Scale Good Leadership and Bad Leadership:*** *The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken* by Liz Corey · Toolbox No. 2

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

1. Keep it open in every AI conversation you lead.
2. Set one rule: no product names and no acronyms until the speaker has described, in plain business language, the work the technology would change.
3. Translate every technical claim back into work, risk, and outcome. Use the question beside each term.

THE FIVE TERMS

The only form you need

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS	ASK THIS IN THE MEETING
The prediction engine	AI generates plausible language from patterns. It predicts. It does not know. It has never read your company.	*What is it predicting from, and has it ever seen our data?*
The assignment	AI output quality tracks delegation quality. Structure every request as Goal, Context, Constraints, Output.	*Show me the request, not just the result.*
The confident fabrication	When the model does not know, it fills the gap fluently. Fluent never means factual. Price every use case by its verification cost.	*What does it cost us to check this, and who checks it?*
The grounding	Connecting AI to your own documents makes it answer from your company's sources. It also means AI inherits your knowledge exactly as it stands.	*Which documents is it answering from, and are they ready? (Toolbox No. 3)*
The delegated worker	An agent pursues outcomes with authority. The moment authority is delegated, workforce rules apply: a job description, decision boundaries, a named human owner.	*Where is its job description, and who owns it? (Toolbox No. 4)*

The payoff. Command of these five terms keeps workforce decisions with the people who understand work.

THE ASSIGNMENT STRUCTURE

Turn every request into a delegation

Goal
The decision or outcome it serves, not a description of the task.

Context
The facts it cannot know: your data, your history, what changed.

Constraints
What it must not do, and what comes back to you for review.

Output
The exact format, length, and what a finished answer contains.

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WORKED EXAMPLE

Same tool. Same data. Ninety seconds of thought.

THE WAY IT USUALLY GOES

"Summarize the engagement survey results for the leadership team."

What comes back:
Competent, generic, and useless. Ten bullet points that could describe any company, no priorities, and nothing anyone can act on.

THE SAME REQUEST AS A DELEGATION

Goal: a summary that helps the executive team decide where to focus in the next quarter, not a description of the data.

Context: eleven hundred responses, 30 percent of the workforce, three months after the reorganization; manager effectiveness scores fell in two of five business units.

Constraints: no individual or team is identifiable; do not speculate about causes the data does not support; flag anything that touches a protected group for my review before it goes anywhere.

Output: one page. Three findings that changed from last cycle, what each one appears to be costing us, and the two questions I should put in front of the executive team.

A document you would actually bring to your CEO.

YOUR TURN

Rebuild one real request from this week

The request as it was written:

Goal What decision or outcome does this serve?

Context What does it need to know that it cannot know on its own?

Constraints What must it not do? What comes back to you for review?

Output What format, what length, what does finished look like?

Check it before you send it

Would you bring the result to your CEO?	☐ Yes	☐ No
Do you know what it costs to check the answer?	☐ Yes	☐ No

The CHRO's move. Run both versions with your own team's request. Show them side by side at your next staff meeting. Ten minutes, and your team will never unsee the difference.

Want every request built this way? The GROWTH Execution Partner turns a one-line request into a full assignment. Call for pricing. Book a conversation at onthegrow.ai

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